

YIHAN ZHAO

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RESEARCH INTERESTS

Early Social Development: Parent-child interaction · Social motivation

Autism Research: Early identification and intervention · Family-centered support

Family Processes: Coparenting · Parent-child relationships · Transition to parenthood · Family systems

Technology-Mediated Assessment & Intervention: Child-AI/Robot interaction · Serious games · Telehealth

EDUCATION

Master of Social Sciences in Counselling

Sep 2024 - Oct 2025

City University of Hong Kong | Hong Kong

- GPA: 3.40 | Top 10%

B.S. in Psychology (Biology)

Aug 2019 - Dec 2021

University of California, Davis | Davis, CA, USA

- GPA: 3.40 | Dean's List, 2020-2021

PUBLICATIONS & MANUSCRIPTS

Zhao, Y., Zhang, L., Li, K., Ke, S., Lu, S., & Zeng, G. (2026). *The Gift of the Tenth Month: Early Design of a Partner-Inclusive Prenatal Education Serious Game*. Companion Proceedings of the Annual Symposium on Computer-Human Interaction in Play (CHI PLAY Companion '26). ACM. doi:10.1145/3800965.3834320

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS & SUBMISSIONS

Li, K., Chen, Y., Zhao, Y., & Zeng, G. (2026). *Computational Modeling of Facial Trustworthiness Perception on Action Units Using Machine Learning*. Oral presentation, the 14th Conference for Chinese Psychologists.

Zhao, Y., & Zeng, G. (2026). *Toddlers' Visual Attention to Social Interactions Varies Across Physical Contexts*. Abstract in preparation for submission to the 2027 Society for Research in Child Development Biennial Meeting.

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Lab Manager / Research Assistant, SEED Lab

Jun 2025 - Present

The Chinese University of Hong Kong, Shenzhen | PI: Prof. Guangyu Zeng

- Manage ongoing research with approximately 100 families of infants aged 5–24 months, including family follow-up, scheduling of ~230 experimental visits, parent–child interaction sessions, eye-tracking data collection and analysis, and RA scheduling.
- Design and lead nature-based outdoor activities for approximately 50 families with children aged 2–5 years, and coordinate and adjust team assignments.
- Develop and refine study protocols and IRB materials and help translate ongoing projects into research outputs including conference abstracts, posters, and manuscript drafts.
- Completed SCS training and qualified as a reliable coder for recorded parent–child interactions; train and coordinate 15+ graduate and undergraduate RAs across participant procedures, data collection, and study protocols.

Research Assistant, TEPE (Tracing Effective Preschool Education) Project

Nov 2024 - Jan 2025; Apr 2025 - Jun 2025

The Chinese University of Hong Kong, Shenzhen | PI: Prof. Runke Huang

- Led a fieldwork team for developmental data collection across 44 kindergartens in Shenzhen, coordinating researcher schedules, assessment materials, site visits, and study records.
- Administered IDELA assessments with preschool children and improved the paper-based workflow for data collection, recording, and verification to make fieldwork and data handling more efficient.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Direct Support Professional

Apr 2022 - May 2023

Summer House Inc., | Davis, CA, USA

- Provided individualized support to 12 adults with intellectual and developmental disabilities, including daily living, community participation, communication, and social interaction.
- Worked directly with residents and their support teams to implement individualized routines and behavioral support plans.

RESEARCH & TECHNICAL SKILLS

Research Methods: Eye-tracking data collection and analysis · EEG data collection · fNIRS data collection

Technical Tools: R / RStudio · SPSS · Tobii Pro Lab · ELAN · BORIS · Godot Engine 4

Languages: Mandarin Chinese (Native) · English (Professional) · Cantonese (Basic)